

Stripe 101 Travel & Expense and Employee Detailed Reimbursement Policy

Summary

This document provides guidance to Stripes on what can and cannot be expensed when traveling for business or incurring expenses on behalf of the company. On the following pages, you will find;

- Key travel processes and air/hotel spend policy
- Eligible business expenses
- Guidance on expense submission and approval process
- Appropriate use of the Navan Corporate Card

Who does this apply to?

This document will apply to all Stripes globally. Contingent workers should reach out to their contracting agencies for information relating to their travel and expense policies.

Policy Statement

The Stripe Travel and Expense Policy (T&E) is defined and shaped by our operating principles, and has been developed to promote efficiency and clarity with the expectation that Stripes behave in a humble mindset.

This policy covers the most frequent expenses incurred across the Travel and Expense process but is non-exhaustive. We place a lot of trust in our employees, including how they spend on behalf of Stripe. As a general rule, apply good judgment and consider that expense claims should always pass the 'front page test'.

With that in mind, this policy strives to;

- Make it easy for employees to travel safely and productively
- Ensure employees are thoughtful about their expenditures and act in the best interest of Stripe
- Provide clear guidelines on what can and cannot be reimbursed on an expense claim
- Ensure compliance with internal and external policies, requirements with the IRS and other local regulations and laws

1.0 Travel

If you have an emergency while traveling, contact local police, fire, or medical services in your current location. Use [this](#) guide for a listing of emergency services in each country. You may also contact our 24/7 Global Security Operations Center (GSOC) at +1-415-766-2212 or gsoc@stripe.com for safety and security support.

Stripe leverages a global travel solution, Navan, to manage the travel booking process for all Stripes. This service provides greater customer support and booking efficiencies for employees while also allowing Stripe to manage your health and safety while traveling (leveraging our security tool, iSOS). Employees are required to use Navan when making business travel arrangements for all air, hotel, and rental car reservations.

Air travel booked through Navan will be centrally paid through Navan's Liquid Card (leveraging Stripe Issuing) which removes the need to submit these expenses for reimbursement.

Hotel bookings will be paid through your corporate credit card or personal credit card which requires submission through our travel partner.

Approval Process

Any out-of-policy bookings within Navan will require Manager approval. This is a soft-stop approval process which means the travel will be booked if no action is taken by your Manager within a certain period of time (12-24hrs approval window depending on if your manager sits in a different continental location). This process is managed through an email/app notification from Navan.

Detailed T&E spend data will also be shared with our budgeting teams on a monthly basis for review with business budget owners which will include a break-down of out-of-policy travel bookings and spend.

Extending Travel for personal reasons

Stripe allows travelers to extend their trips under certain circumstances.

1.1 Air Transportation

Employees should book the most practical and economic travel available.

- Practical = nonstop flights leaving and arriving at reasonable distances from home and destination
- Economic = Purchase the ticket type to suit your needs. Fully refundable fares are not required if the flight dates are easily adjustable.
- Booked in advance, but no less than 14-days before departure (exceptions allowed for business emergencies)

You may expense one checked piece of luggage at the standard weight if it is not covered by the cost of the flight. Certain exceptions may occur if there is a business requirement for extra baggage (e.g. transporting sales materials for a conference).

The allowed air class can be seen in the table below. In order to qualify for the increased flight class, a single leg must be over 10 continuous hours.

Flight Time Under 10 hours	Flight Time Over 10 hours
Coach/Economy	Premium Economy
Note - There are some exceptions to our default policy based on approved medical exceptions, heavy travelers, seniority, etc. Navan highlights out-of-policy content during the booking process. If an airline does not have premium economy options, an upgrade is not applicable (go down to the next available fare).	

Flight costs spike closer to the departure date with some last minute fares not offering value. Lower air class fares can be purchased to extend T&E budgets. Please use your best judgment when booking last minute travel.

Heavy Travelers - Employees traveling on frequent business trips may book premium economy once they reach a certain threshold of travel.

- If an employee has 10+ trips longer than 4-hours in a given 12-month period (e.g Employee travels from NY to SF every 2-weeks.
- On trip 11 and thereafter, the company will pay for the employee to travel premium economy)
- Manager pre-approval is required before this change can be made.
- If you are eligible for this upgrade, contact the T&E team for more information

Navan also allows travelers to personally pay for their flight class upgrade within their booking tool.

Airport lounges, CLEAR access or Global Entry are not reimbursable expenses.

If you have restrictions that should be considered with regards to travel and think you need an accommodation, please reach out to accommodations@stripe.com or fill out the [form here](#) so our team may assist them directly. Accommodations will be made on a case by case basis with the accommodations team.

1.2 Lodging/Accommodation

Employee safety is our key concern when overnight stays are booked. Please ensure an adequate level of review is done before booking any hotel/accommodation. Feel free to reach out to your manager if you

are unfamiliar with the area. If you feel unsafe at any point during your stay, please reach out to our gsoc team by emailing them: gsoc@stripe.com or calling (855) 560-0086 (U.S. Toll free) or +1 (415) 766-2212 for assistance.

Hotel

Hotels should not exceed \$300 (or local currency equivalent) per night and the hotel should be at least 3-star quality. This allowance increases to \$350 in SF, NY, Tokyo and London.

Navan offers an “optimal price” algorithm within their booking tool. This price will show the fair market rate per night based on the selection criteria. When this “optimal price” falls below the \$300 threshold, this becomes the allowable nightly rate.

The \$300 threshold may be exceeded if a business emergency, or urgent key meeting is required. A relevant comment must be added within the booking to clarify this exception and will be reviewed. If you need to make a change last minute and your hotel will incur a costly change fee, please contact peoplesupport@stripe.com.

Airbnb/Short Term Lets

Airbnb and other short-term lets are not permissible under the T&E policy. They do not satisfy our security and duty-of-care requirements and cause considerable risk for our travelers.

Accommodation Cost Management Guidance

- If costs significantly exceed the suggestions above, consider postponing your business travel or exploring more affordable lodging options.
- Employees are responsible for canceling hotel room reservations before the hotel’s cancellation deadline.
- Employees are personally responsible for “no-show charges”.
- Stripe will not reimburse for such charges unless it is the result of business requirements.

1.3 Ground Transportation

Taxis/Ride sharing companies

Taxis, Uber/Lyft are reimbursable as long as it relates to business activity. (e.g Airport to hotel, hotel to office, office to airport.) You may join [Stripe's Uber for Business](#) corporate account on day 1 of employment. We are not allowing rental cars for Stripe 101 Onboarding.

Please ensure economy single passenger cars are booked. Expenses for your normal daily commute (i.e your home to the office) are not reimbursable.

Personal Car (Mileage)

Stripe reimburses employees who use a personal car for business with the approved reimbursable rate. The mileage reimbursement provided under the Stripe Travel and Expense policy is intended to cover all expenses associated with operating personal vehicles for business travel including the cost of insurance.

Employees that elect to utilize their personal automobiles for “business purposes” are expected to purchase and maintain third party liability insurance with limits that meet local compulsory insurance requirements.

“Business Purposes” simply refers to whether or not the costs associated with the usage of a personally owned or rented vehicle are eligible for reimbursement under the Stripe corporate travel and expense policy.

Insurance deductibles, traffic citations, parking fines, and the daily commute between home and office are not reimbursable.

Parking & Tolls

Employees may expense parking receipts and tolls when they relate to business travel. Any parking relating to the office commute is managed through Benefits (if available) and you’ll be able to register after day 1 of employment.

If traveling to the airport, please leverage taxi/ride-share rather than using airport parking when possible.

Rail/Train

The default class of service for rail travel is generally standard class but exceptions are allowed where a higher class is required to book a seat or avail of wi-fi.

1.4 Travel Insurance/Travel Related Items (Visas, Passports, Inoculations)

Stripe offers a company wide travel insurance policy. If you would like more detailed information, please email peoplesupport@stripe.com.

Visas, passports and inoculations are reimbursable if required for business travel. It is the responsibility of the employee to research and obtain correct visas prior to travel. Navan has an internal service through VisaHQ that provides additional visa information based on travel parameters and should be reviewed before travel booking.

Stripe sponsored relocation expenses are primarily managed through the Global Mobility team.

1.5 Traveling with non-Stripes

If you are bringing family and/or significant others on a Stripe business trip, you are responsible for the incremental cost of their travel, including meals and other daily expenses.

Stripe will not cover any lost costs associated with personal travel if the business trip is canceled or moved. It is the employees' risk to book personal travel in this situation.

2.0 Navan Corporate Credit Card

Corporate credit cards are issued directly through the Navan solution and should be the primary form of payment for Travel and Expense spend. These cards will be issued in GBP/EUR/USD denominations depending on your work location.

The Corporate Card must be your primary form of payment when traveling. The cardholder is required to review all spend notifications and immediately freeze or mark the card as lost/stolen as required.

3.0 Other Business Expenses

The following section outlines the guidance around the common business expenses that occur while traveling and also Stripe specific allowances and benefits offered to employees.

3.1 Meals while traveling

There is an allowance of \$75 - \$100 per day for food when traveling. This is not a per diem rule; only actual meal costs are eligible for reimbursement.

If you're visiting a Stripe office that provides meals, then you should eat at the Stripe office. If you're traveling for work over the weekend, you may expense your meals.

Your \$75 - \$100 per day food allowance cannot be combined with the \$100 allowance for team entertainment/dinners. The expectation is that any traveler will have reduced food spend on the days where there is a team event with food provided.

All T&E spend will ultimately hit overall T&E budgets so any overspend will impact future event planning.

Stripe won't cover (a) meals for your significant other, children, or friends, (b) incidentals, such as newspapers or magazines. Alcohol is allowed but we expect employees to comply with the employee handbook.

3.2 Client Meals/Entertainment

Client Meals/Entertainment are expenses incurred with clients, prospects, or associates where Stripe related business is discussed. A Stripe and a named external business contact must be included as an

attendee when submitting the expense for approval before it can be classified as a business expense. Always keep in mind the [Stripe Code of Conduct](#) during these interactions.

You may expense business meals with partners, press, and users. As a guideline, don't exceed \$100 USD per person on a business meal or event.

3.3 Benefits

[Benefits](#), including the education stipend, are submitted through [Forma](#). You will be able to register once you join Stripe.

3.4 Professional Memberships/Subscriptions

Professional Membership fees (ACCA/State Bar fees etc.) are reimbursable if they are indispensable to your role. Please discuss with your lead prior to purchasing.

3.5 Wi-Fi

Airport, in-flight, and hotel internet access are covered during business travel only. Home wi-fi is not reimbursable.

3.6 Cell Phone Allowance

Stripe offers a Cell Phone subsidy to those employees who use their personal phone for work purposes. This is managed through an extra payment through your monthly paycheck. You will enroll after you join Stripe.

3.7 Fully Remote workers

[Fully remote workers](#) get an initial allowance and equipment refreshes to build out their home working space.. More information on this stipend can be found [here](#). This is now primarily managed through a Forma wallet. A subset of users will have a refresher allowance that will be managed through Navan.

If you are required to travel to any office, as approved by your manager, your travel and overnight stay is reimbursable in accordance with company travel policies.

Managers, this should be restricted to onsite travel where possible. General office commuting expenses are not allowed.

Any travel relating to social visits is not reimbursable. Travel budgets for remote workers fall within the overall team budgets so please work with your lead to manage accordingly.

3.8 Team Onsites

Stripe managers should be thoughtful about the size, location, and timing of onsite for their team and keep overall costs to a minimum. Be conscious to avoid peak travel periods for the desired location where costs can inflate 2x-3x normal. Onsite spend will be part of team's overall T&E budgets and must be managed accordingly

Onsites must be planned at the Stripe office where most of the Stripes on the team reside. If a team is not predominantly assigned to one office or is entirely remote, onsite should still take place in a Stripe office and planned in a way that minimizes the total amount of travel for the team.

Offsites are off-limits without LT pre-approval.

Important: when submitting expenses for reimbursement or booking flights for onsite on Navan, please use the "Team Onsite" tag! FYI, the Navan Team Travel booking process is not available for use at this time.

3.9 Team Entertainment/Dinners

Employee entertainment is a T&E audit focus area globally and must be managed carefully. In order to ensure Stripe manages this spend in a compliant manner, we need to ensure our spend is reasonable and inclusive within the parameters of tax guidance.

Team Entertainment/Dinners will be managed under the overall T&E Budget but an allocation of \$100 (or local currency equivalent) per FTE per event should still apply. Events should be limited to 1-2 events per quarter and spend must fall within overall T&E budgets.

Events should be all-inclusive, benefit the team and are not intended for birthdays, flowers, baby gifts, etc. Any extra costs relating to a team outing will impact your team's overall T&E budget.

Regarding alcohol, the policy is 1-2 drinks per person per event. The \$100 per person allowance allows for food, drink and entertainment (e.g. bowling) purchases. Any spend beyond that point is not reimbursable. We expect employees to comply with the employee handbook during these events.

All T&E spend will ultimately hit overall T&E budgets so any overspend will impact future event planning.

We expect budget owners/DRI's to exercise good judgment when planning any internal entertainment to ensure events are inclusive and reasonable and within the guidelines outlined in the Stripe Code of Conduct

3.10 Swag

Swag is centrally managed by the Workplace team and should not be expensed.

3.11 Non-Reimbursable Expenses

The non-exhaustible list of items below are not covered by the Travel Policy. Items outside of the Policy include, but are not limited to:

- Personal items and services purchased while traveling are not reimbursable (i.e. toiletries, clothing, cosmetics, shoe shine, etc.)
- Personal entertainment (sightseeing tours, cinema, theatre, etc.)
- Barber/hairstylist
- Cash advances and related ATM/cash withdrawal fees
- Charitable donations (Pre-approval required. Contact Tax team for the correct process as this is deductible expense)
- Personal credit card membership fees
- Finance charges or annual fees on personal credit cards used for business
- House-sitting or pet-sitting/boarding fees
- Local car rental or alternative transportation when personal car is in for repair
- Repairs, maintenance or insurance on personal car
- Lost or damaged luggage
- Luggage or briefcases
- Request for reimbursement of travel paid by frequent flyer miles
- Traffic fines
- Expenses related to staying with friends or family members
- Expenses related to vacation or personal days while on a business trip for employee or travel companion
- Daily/Annual Airline Club Access
- CLEAR membership
- Items covered by the Twic allowance

4.0 Submitting Expenses

Cash and Corporate Credit Card expense transactions must be submitted through our Expense Management tool, for review and approval.

Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of the transaction occurring. Fully approved expenses allow our budgeting team to correctly forecast and manage future T&E budgets for your team.

Employees and their delegates are responsible for the accuracy and completeness of their expense reports as well as ensuring they are submitted in a timely manner and compliant with Stripe policies.

4.1 Receipts

All cash expenses require an attached itemized receipt to support the spend.

US Employees are not required to attach receipts for corporate card transactions below **\$75** (as per IRS requirements) as long as a valid business purpose and names of the attendees (if applicable) are added.

Global Entities - Itemized receipts are required for all transactions in our global entities (due to tax requirements)

Credit card receipts alone are not acceptable, as (1) they do not allow finance to assess the business justification of the expense and (2) they are not sufficient for tax purposes. The use of third party payment intermediaries (e.g. PayPal) for expense lines must include a receipt of the actual good or service provided that includes the supplier's name, address, description of services/items and date of purchase.

4.2 Submission Policy

Please submit your expenses no later than 30 days following the spend. Unsubmitted spend prevents us from accurately accounting for T&E spend, and opens Stripe us to various levels of risk.

4.3 Employee Reimbursement back to Stripe

Employees must reimburse Stripe for any personal spend on their corporate card, reimbursed personal cash expenses, duplicate expenses or excess use of stipends for which they have been reimbursed for. Please contact Finance-Services if you have any questions or need to highlight accidental personal spend.

4.4 Exceptions

Any spending exceptions should be pre-approved by the business budget owner/planning DRI.

Exceptions will be reviewed and tracked in a consistent manner. Any pre-approvals must be noted through either attaching a screenshot of the approval when expensing or noting the approvals in the comment section.

5.0 Contact information

The primary owner of this Policy is Finance-Operations with input from Legal, People-Ops, and other teams. This policy links to other internal services and processes, the management of such processes sit with those teams.

All T&E related queries should be directed to the Travel and Expense team.

FAQ

Travel

Q: Do I have to book my travel through Navan?

Yes, Stripe requires a centralized travel management process to manage both employee safety and our increasing spend as we scale as a company.

Q: Will I keep my reward points when booking through Navan?

Yes, you can input all your hotel/air rewards programs into Navan and collect points as you normally would. Some content on Navan is managed through 3rd party providers which may not offer points, but these are clearly marked during the booking process.

Q: How do I download the Navan mobile app?

You can download the Navan app through the Apple play store and then link through google authentication.

You must set up your profile through the Navan webUI before linking your account with your mobile app.

Q: How do I cancel or change an existing flight/hotel booking?

Navan allows users to self-serve flight changes or cancellations through a really simple process found on their platform. You don't need to spend hours contacting the air/hotel customer support team to try to manage this.

Q: How do I pay for travel?

Travel spend will be paid using a different process for Air travel and other spend booked through Navan. This is due to a difference between the supplier types and what they can accept as payment.

- Air travel will be covered by the Navan Liquid payment process which will be paid through the booking platform with no extra work required by users.
- Hotel/Car rental spend will be covered by individually held corporate credit cards (or your personal credit card if you don't have a corp card). Any employee expense reimbursement will take place by leveraging the standard process for your entity.

Q: Is there an approval process for travel booked through Navan?

There is an approval process for travelers if bookings are outside what is allowed by the Travel and Expense Policy. All out-of-policy travel will be sent to your direct manager for approval through either the mobile app or email notification.

This approval is a soft-stop approval which means that if there is no response from your manager within a period of time (6-12hrs) depending on your location, the travel will be booked.

This time-limit is due to how long Navan may hold flights/hotels at a certain price without booking. Please work directly with your manager if this situation arises and provide adequate context during the booking process explaining the exception.

Q: What is the guidance for travel and team meeting costs?

In general, there should be a clear business case for any travel. Such reasons may include client meetings, project launches, and key strategic meetings.

We also recognize the importance of team meetings and offsites as a way of developing internal teams.

In order to understand if travel is necessary, please work with your manager to review the trip, and assess whether it fits the requirements to justify the costs.

Managers, your team's spend must fall within your overall T&E budget so please plan accordingly. We understand that certain teams will have more of a business need than others to travel and your budget will reflect that. For internal meetings, and team events, please try to leverage a mix of virtual events as well as in-person events.

Q: May I expense airport meals?

Yes. If you are missing a meal due to business travel.

Q: May I expense groceries in lieu of meals while traveling for work?

No. This is not allowed under the current T&E policy.

Q: May I expense a gift card or be reimbursed for staying with a friend or fellow Stripe?

No. Reimbursing Stripes for gifts and encouraging informal hosting arrangements exposes us to compliance and legal risks.

Q: May I expense the cost of house sitters, caregivers, babysitters, pet sitters, etc., while traveling for work?

No. Maintaining these expenses are your responsibility, regardless of whether you are at home or traveling for Stripe. Stripe covers the cost of your travel only.

If your business travel imposes an undue financial burden due to unexpected additional expenses caused by your travel, you should discuss with your manager whether your situation is an exception to this guidance.

Flights

Q: May I upgrade to a flight class that exceeds the T&E policy allowance?

If not otherwise allowed under the T&E policy, you can upgrade your flight at your own expense. Stripe will not cover the cost of this upgrade.

Navan can support that request using the process below.

- Book the flight as normal
- Contact the Navan support team through their chat functionality
- Request they book a class upgrade with the payment hitting your personal credit card.
 - Note - these credit card details must be added to your Navan profile in order for the support team to manage this process.

If you have health issues or exceptions that require a different class of travel, please refer to the accommodations process listed in the T&E Policy.

Q: If premium economy is not available on a specific international route, can business be booked as an exception?

No. Employees should seek the flights that meet their needs and an increasing number of airlines offer premium economy. If those flights do not support the approved class, then the next class down is the compliant option.

Q: Is there an extra allowance for red-eye flights?

No. We will review this policy annually to confirm industry norms and practices.

Q: May I book fully refundable flights?

No. Please do not book fully refundable flights. When booking, make sure you book the standard rate. These flights generally allow you to change the date/time for a nominal fee if your plans change. This is the much cheaper option, and should be leveraged when booking flights.

Hotels

Q: What type of hotel should I book for business travel?

Employee safety is our top priority. The lowest class hotel you should book is a 3 star hotel. Stripe's hotel allowance is generous enough to cover 4 star hotels in most city locations. If you find the nightly rate is far outside the allowed threshold, there may be a large event occurring in the city at that time. Please consider adjusting your travel dates to reduce your costs.

During the current travel restrictions, employees are expected to be aware of the refund policies for each booking. If there is a chance the trip may not take place, please book a refundable rate or wait as close as possible to book the hotel stay.

Q: What should I do if the hotel is not to the expected standard?

If you feel there is a threat to your personal safety, please contact local police, fire, or medical services in your current location. Use [this](#) guide for a listing of emergency services in each country. Please ensure you contact our GSOC g-soc team by emailing them: gsoc@stripe.com or calling (855) 560-0086 (U.S. Toll free) or +1 (415) 766-2212 for assistance.

If the problem is in relation to the quality/service in the hotel, please contact the internal hotel staff first to see if they can remedy the problem. If the problem persists after contacting hotel staff, contact the Navan support team to assist. Depending on the issue, they may escalate the issue, or recommend booking a new hotel.

If this situation occurs, please ensure you reach out to the [Travel and Expense team](#) so we can take action internally and either remove the hotel from our corporate listing, or ensure a better class of service is provided to Stripe employees.

Q: May I expense laundry?

Yes, if you are traveling for work for more than 10 business days. You may want to see if it is cheaper to check a second piece of luggage. Avoid laundry services in a hotel or dry cleaning; they charge a significant premium.

Personal travel

Q: What does extending my trip for personal reasons mean?

This is the practice of combining business travel and leisure travel into one trip. This can mean taking a week's PTO directly after a trip to a Stripe office, or simply spending an extra night in a city while traveling for work. If you are not extending your trip for a specific business purpose, this constitutes personal travel.

Stripe expects its employees to operate in a humble mindset while traveling and trusts you to determine the appropriate length of your business travel. Please ensure you create a separation between the business and personal portions of your trips -- when in doubt, your manager can provide a reasonableness check.

Q: How do I manage the costs associated with extending my trip for personal reasons?

Stripe will not cover any costs once the portion of your trip becomes personal in nature.

Stripe will not cover any lost costs associated with personal travel if the business trip is canceled or moved. It is the employees' risk to book personal travel in this situation.

Flights

There should be a limited difference (\$100) between the costs of the return flights if personal travel takes place. (\$ flight on business trip end date - \$ flight on personal trip end date)

If this is the case then the return flight is regarded as a business expense and treated in the same manner as normal travel.

Hotels

If you want to stay in the same accommodation for the personal portion of your trip, please book the business portion of your trip through Navan. You can then directly contact the hotel and request that extra nights be added to the booking with the payment hitting your personal card. This ensures that you will be able to stay in the same room and creates the separation between the business/personal payments.

Q: Can I book my personal companion's travel through Navan?

No. Your travel companion should book directly with the airline and then you should manage your booking in Navan so your travel is connected.

Q: Are there any other considerations I have to think of when I extend my trip for personal reasons?

Please be aware of Stripe's travel guidance around personal safety and data security when moving from business travel to personal travel. You will have sensitive Stripe equipment (work-phone/mac) during the personal portion of your trip so please ensure these items are kept secure.

Ground Transportation

Q: May I expense airport parking?

Yes. Please use the cheapest option to manage this spend where possible. Generally, taxis, Ubers/Lyfts, or public transportation are much cheaper but please consider your personal situation when making the decision. If these options are not viable, or add a large amount of time to the journey, please leverage the parking option.

Q: May I expense transportation to and from a Stripe office and an event or user meeting?

Yes. If there is a direct business purpose for the travel, then you may expense it. If the purpose is social or more for general business networking, then the cost is not expensable.

Social events with other Stripes do not have a direct business purpose, and associated costs like transportation should not be treated as an expenses

Q: May I expense a taxi or Uber if I am working late?

No. The exception is if you feel unsafe. If it is a persistent issue, you should re-evaluate your transportation plans, leveraging our commuting benefits described at go/benefits, which include safety ride options for some offices.

General Expenses

Q: May I expense meals when the office is closed?

No. Unless you are traveling for work, Stripe does not reimburse meals when offices are closed.

Q: May I expense alcohol?

Yes. We expect that all Stripes will comply with the Global Employee Handbook. Please be responsible about expensing alcohol. A good rule of thumb is one drink per person per meal (meal = dinner). This includes team dinners when traveling for work.

Q: May I expense additional phone charges while traveling for work?

You will be able to review our phone charges policy once you start.

Q: May I expense user events and meals?

Yes. User events and meals should be approved by your manager. Approved user events and meals may be expensed. Remember to follow the receipt and documentation required outlined above.

Q: May I expense social activities with Stripes?

Yes. Please follow guidelines drafted by our Events team once you join and ensure you stay within the Team's Fun / Recognition budget. When expensing, include details such as purpose, attendees, and the name of the manager that signed off on the expense when submitting the expense reimbursement. This helps Stripe comply with external regulations.

Q: May I expense birthday or baby gifts to other Stripes?

No. There is a significant tax risk associated with gifts that are expensed as a business expense. In order to reduce this risk, we do not allow gifts to be expensed.

Q: How do I submit Benefit allowances?

Benefits, including the education stipend, are submitted through Forma, which you will be able to register for once you join Stripe.

Q: Can I expense internet access on flights?

Yes, if you're using it to work on behalf of Stripe. We appreciate you might want to use the time on the flight for "focused" work. There is no expectation that you will work on the flight, though.

Q: Does Stripe pay for professional dues?

Yes. If your job at Stripe requires a professional certification or membership to a trade association, please discuss with your manager if those costs are reimbursable. Please note your manager's approval in your expense report.

Q: Speaking of Manager approval, is one required for expense reimbursement?

Maybe. Most expenses are compliant with the T&E policy, properly supported and easily identifiable as a business expense. For expenses outside of the “ordinary”, we will forward the expense to your manager for approval. Manager approval is required before processing the reimbursement. If in doubt, always err on the side of over-communicating the rationale of the expense.